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COVID shot confusion? Read on.

Are they available? Are they covered? Do I need them? Here are some answers.

By Jason Laughlin, Kay Lazar, and Marin Wolf
GLOBE STAFF

With all the uncertainty surrounding the CDC in recent days, you may have questions about the changing health landscape.

On Friday, a team of Globe health reporters sought to clear up some of the confusion by answering questions from readers on the availability of vaccines as we head into the traditional respiratory virus season.

With Governor Healey's announcement authorizing pharmacies to make vaccines

available to any resident, does this mean our insurance providers are required to cover the immunizations?

On Thursday, the Massachusetts Division of Insurance and Department of Public Health announced they will require insurance carriers in the state to continue to cover vaccines that are recommended by the state public health agency, regardless of Centers for Disease Control and Prevention guidance. That includes both shots that protect against respiratory viruses, like the flu, RSV, and COVID, and routine childhood vaccinations, including measles, chickenpox and Hepatitis B.

I'm an adult in Massachusetts. How do you suggest I go about getting a COVID vaccine?

There are a couple of ways you can get it in Massachusetts. As of Wednesday, pharmacists in the state can give updated COVID shots without the permission of a CDC vaccine panel called the Advisory Committee on Immunization. This means that major pharmacies like Walgreens and CVS can start giving the new doses once they receive their shipments. You can also talk to your doctor about whether their office is offering the shot.

While the vaccine is now available to everyone over the age of 5 in Massachusetts, **COVID, Page A7**



Labor market cools with economy

August jobs numbers far below expectations

By Lydia DePillis
NEW YORK TIMES

After persevering through years of high interest rates and wild swings in economic policy, the labor market appears to be sputtering, in a slow-down that could build on itself as consumers lose confidence and pull back on spending.

Employers added only 22,000 jobs in August, well below the number that forecasters had expected. The unemployment rate rose very slightly to 4.3 percent, showing both that businesses' appetite for new recruits and the number of available job-seekers have faded in the last several months.

The economy has been cooling since its red-hot pandemic peak as the Federal Reserve worked to tame inflation, and has more recently been buffeted by a barrage of tariffs and other disruptive actions by the Trump administration.

Employers haven't been letting go of workers in large numbers, but employees have also been hanging on tightly to their jobs. That leaves little room for anyone entering the job market for the first time, or trying to get back in after losing work.

"Once you turn negative, you usually do so rapidly," said Diane Swonk, chief US economist for the accounting firm KPMG. "When the pace of hiring, the pace of layoffs, and the pace of quits **JOBS, Page A6**

Mass. Cass neighbors speak out: 'We can't wait any longer'



MATTHEW J. LEE/GLOBE STAFF

Nivia Piña with her husband, Hector, owners of Doña Habana Restaurant, said they'll likely have to close it because of crime.

At a hearing, South End residents and business owners express frustrations with continuing drug use, break-ins, and homelessness

By Nick Stoico and Niki Griswold
GLOBE STAFF

Angry residents and business owners in the South End are demanding action from city leaders over illicit drug use and persistent crime in the area known as Mass. and Cass.

So many attended a City Council hearing Thursday evening that the crowd spilled out of a meeting room at the Hampton Inn and Suites, near the troubled intersection of Massachusetts Avenue and Melnea Cass Boulevard.

One by one, people stepped to a microphone to recount a multitude of incidents at their homes and neighborhood, including break-ins, people injecting opioids on their front steps, and public defecation and urination.

"Just experience one day out on my patio and you will understand," said Nivia Piña, who with her

husband owns Doña Habana Restaurant on a section of Melnea Cass where hordes of homeless people frequently congregate.

"They throw whatever they want, they use the barriers as ladders to go inside our property and destroy our property. Nobody pays for that, and we're not asking for money, we're not asking for anything," Piña said. "We're just asking for the city to think outside of the box and stop these meetings."

Piña said business has plummeted due to the homelessness and drug use outside. She said she's depleted her 401(k) to keep the restaurant open, but it will likely have to close, costing about 40 people their jobs.

She was among the 120-plus people who signed up to speak during the four-hour meeting, a measure of the deep frustration over the persistent drug

MASS. AND CASS, Page A10

Ex-councilor Fernandes Anderson gets month in prison

By Shelley Murphy
GLOBE STAFF

Former Boston city councilor Tania Fernandes Anderson was sentenced Friday to one month in prison for taking a \$7,000 kickback inside a City Hall bathroom from a relative who worked on her staff.

Acknowledging her crime, Fernandes Anderson said she was disgusted by what she had done, as she made an emotional plea for leniency during the sentencing hearing in federal court in Boston and also sought forgiveness from God, her family, friends, and constituents.

"There is no excuse," she said, her voice cracking as she spoke at length and struggled for composure. "I feel disgusting, like I can't forgive myself."

She urged US District Judge Indira Talwani not to send her to prison for the sake of her children, "to spare them the pain of separating from me."

The judge denied that request, insisting that some prison time was necessary because of the seriousness of the offense.

"There's no question you knew it was wrong," **SENTENCE, Page A10**



Tania Fernandes Anderson admitted taking a kickback.



Miss the bolt

Saturday: A storm or two. High 83-88. Low 62-67.

Sunday: Rain early. High 68-73. Low 56-61. Sunrise: 6:15 Sunset: 7:09

Weather and Comics, D4-5.

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Everett Mayor Carlo DeMaria is seeking a court ruling to back up his interpretation of the ordinance that awarded him longevity bonuses. **B1.**

Israel struck a high-rise building in Gaza City after an evacuation warning, as the military stepped up operations. **A4.**

The Red Sox need their veterans down the stretch, writes Chad Finn. **C1.**

Experimental use of drug gives cancer patient new hope

By Amanda Gokee
GLOBE STAFF

CONCORD, N.H. — In May, Robb Jutton was so sick, he wasn't sure he'd be alive for his daughter's graduation, just a few weeks away.

Neither was his doctor, who put Jutton's odds of making it at about 50 percent. Jutton had stage 4 thyroid cancer, and scans showed it had spread to nearly every part of his body.

But there was a sliver of hope: an experimental treatment that only a handful of patients around the world had tried. It involved using a drug off-label and had serious risks associated with it, but Jutton, 51, opted in. He called it "a no-brainer."

"The options were do this and probably feel better, or don't do this and die," Jutton said.

CANCER, Page A7



WINSLOW TOWNSON FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

KICKING IT OFF — Matthew Lule (8) and Yaniel Belliard (12) of St. Mary's led their team onto the field for their first game of the season against Swampscott in Lynn. More on the high-school season openers, **C6.**